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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 2 : Session – 6 | Program for Self-regulation and Health

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. Health is a 'natural outcome' of self-regulation because when the Self takes responsibility (sanyam) for the body, it naturally ensures the right inputs — balanced food, rest, exercise, hygiene, avoidance of intoxicants — and the body, being physico-chemical and law-abiding, responds with fitness. SELF-REGULATION = the Self's feeling of responsibility for nurturing, protecting and rightly utilising the body. HEALTH = the body's state of harmony/readiness to serve the Self. One need not chase health directly; live in self-regulation and health follows.
2. Q2. PROGRAM for health, in priority order: (1) AHAR (intake) — right, balanced, timely food suited to the body's need; (2) internal care — proper digestion/elimination and rest/sleep; (3) SHRAM (labour) — physical work contributing to production; (4) VYAYAM (exercise) — regular exercise to keep the body flexible and strong; (5) ASAN-PRANAYAM (postures and breath regulation) for finer harmony; (6) AUSHADH (medicine) and CHIKITSA (treatment) — only when the above fail. Priority flows from daily self-care to external medical intervention as the last resort.
3. Q3. LABOUR = physical work done with a purpose of production/utility — e.g., farming, cleaning the house, carpentry; it exercises the body WHILE producing something useful. EXERCISE = physical activity done specifically for the body's fitness — e.g., jogging, gym, yoga stretches. Labour integrates body-use with meaningful work; exercise compensates when life provides too little labour. Ideally, right labour reduces the separate need for exercise.
4. Q4. SELF-REGULATION vs self-control/self-restraint: self-control is SUPPRESSION — forcing oneself against desire, driven by fear, rules or willpower; it is tense, temporary and often rebounds. SELF-REGULATION (sanyam) is based on UNDERSTANDING — knowing what the body needs and what is valuable, the Self willingly regulates intake and activity; it is relaxed, continuous and stable. Control fights desire; regulation educates it.
5. Q5. REFLECTION: my illnesses in the last three years (viral fever, fatigue from irregular sleep, acidity from junk food) were each restored by rest, regular food timing and sleep — i.e., by returning to self-regulation. DAILY SCHEDULE: 6:30 wake + 30 min exercise; 8:00 breakfast; focused study blocks with posture breaks; 13:00 lunch; evening labour/sport; 22:00 light dinner; 22:30 sleep; no screens before bed. VERDICT: such a schedule makes me MORE productive — energy, concentration and mood all improve when the body is in harmony.